

Hundreds of armed warriors from south- eastern Tibet rode alongside the group to protect the Dalai Lama. Tibetan peasants and monks let them rest in their homes and monasteries along the route. They gave them food, clothing, and fresh horses.

During the journey, the Dalai Lama heard some bad news from the city of Lhasa. After he had left, fighting between the Chinese and Tibetans lasted for three days. Gunfire, death, and sadness filled the streets of Lhasa. About eighty-six thousand Tibetans had been killed. The Chinese bombed